Markus Kneer

Chair of Ethics of AI · IDea_Lab, University of Graz, Leechgasse 34, 8010 Graz, Austria
hello@markuskneer.net · ORCID 0000-0002-4223-0715

Education & Qualifications

2017	**Maître de Conférences, France, Section 17 (Philosophy)**
2015	**PhD in Philosophy, École Normale Supérieure/EHESS, Paris** « Perspective in Language », Supervisor: Prof. F. Recanati. Très honorable avec félicitations du jury (highest possible grade)
2009/10	**Procter Fellow, Princeton University**
2008	**MA in Cognitive Science, École Normale Supérieure/EHESS, Paris** Mention très bien (19/20)
2006–2009	**Élève, École Normale Supérieure, Paris**
2006	**BA in Philosophy, Politics & Economics, Oxford University** First Class Honours in final examinations

Academic Employment

Since 11/2023	**Professor of Ethics of Artificial Intelligence** IDea_Lab, University of Graz
2018–2023	**Principal Investigator, Guilty Minds Lab (840'000 EUR SNF grant)** Centre for Ethics, Dept. of Philosophy, University of Zurich
2022–2023	**Senior Research Associate** Digital Society Initiative, University of Zurich
Spring 2022	**Senior Visiting Fellow** Dept. of Philosophy, University Vita-Salute San Raffaele, Milan
2019–2020	**Fellow** Digital Society Initiative, University of Zurich
2017–2018	**Postdoctoral Researcher** Digital Society Initiative, University of Zurich
2015–2017	**Postdoctoral Researcher** Dept. of History & Philosophy of Science, University of Pittsburgh
Fall 2016	**Humanities & Neuroscience Research Associate** Italian Academy for Advanced Studies, Columbia University

Academic Focus

AoS	Ethics, AI, Cognitive Science
AoC	Philosophy of Mind, Philosophy of Language

Publication Summary

- More than 40 publications in leading peer-reviewed journals in philosophy, cognitive science, computer science and law, as well as in general science journals (PNAS).
- More than 2200 citations (h-index: 24) according to Google Scholar. ResearchGate interest score in top 1% of academics across all disciplines at the same career stage.
- Published with co-authors from philosophy, computer science, cognitive science, law, psychology and economics.

Monographs

With M. Christen, A. Bernstein et al. (2020). Wenn Algorithmen für uns entscheiden: Chancen und Risiken der künstlichen Intelligenz. VDF Hochschulverlag. (When algorithms decide in our stead: Chances and risks of artificial intelligence, in German).

Peer-reviewed Articles and Book Chapters

48 Kneer, M., & Baumgartner, L. (2026). Debiasing Legal Judgement: Outcome Effects in Open-source LLMs. Journal of Institutional and Theoretical Economics, 182(1).

47 Kneer, M. & Haybron, D. M. (2026). Folk theories of well-being: Variation across contexts? Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Vol. 48 (in press).

46 Marsili, N. Blond, R. & Kneer, M. (2026). Posting and Reposting. Investigating the Reputational Effects of Online Communication. Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Vol.48 (in press).

45 Kneer, M. & Haybron, D. M. (2026). Taking the morality out of happiness. Australasian Journal of Philosophy (forthcoming).

44 Güver, L. & Kneer, M. (2025). Causation, Norms and Cognitive Bias. Cognition, 259, 106105.

43 Kneer, M., & Viehoff, J. (2025). The Hard Problem of AI Alignment: Value Forks in Moral Judgment. In Proceedings of the 2025 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (pp. 2671-2681).

42 Tobia, K., Hannikainen, I.R., Kamper, D., Almeida, G., Strohmaier, N., Dranseika, V., Kneer, M. […], Struchiner, N. (2025). The nature of reasonableness. Stanford Journal of International Law, 61, 111.

41 Baumgartner, L., & Kneer, M. (2025). The meaning of 'reasonable': Evidence from a corpus-linguistic study. Forthcoming in Tobia, K. (ed.) The Cambridge Handbook of Experimental Jurisprudence. Cambridge University Press.

40 Kneer, M. & Marsili, N. (2025). The truth about assertion and retraction: A review of the empirical literature. In Wiegmann, A. (ed.) Lying, Fake News, and Bullshit. Bloomsbury Publishing.

39 Mikalonytė, E. S., & Kneer, M. (2024). The folk concept of art. Synthese, 205(1).

37 Kneer, M. & Christen, M. (2024). Responsibility gaps and retributive dispositions: Evidence from the US, Japan and Germany. Science and Engineering Ethics, 30(6):51.

36 Kneer, M., & Haybron, D. M. (2024). Happiness and well-being: Is it all in your head? Evidence from the folk. Noûs 59 (1): 234-268.

35 Christen, M. & Kneer, M. (2024). Mensch-Maschine Kooperation im Sicherheitsbereich. Stratos. Special Issue No.24, p.67-80.

34 Kneer, M., & Haybron, D. (2024). The Folk Concept of the Good Life: Neither Happiness nor Well-Being. Philosophical Studies, 181(10), 2525-2538.

33 Kandul, S., Micheli, V., Beck, J., Burri, T., Fleuret, F., Kneer, M., & Christen, M. (2023). Human control redressed: Comparing AI and human predictability in a real-effort task. Computers in Human Behavior Reports, 10, 100290.

32 Kneer, M. & Skoczen, I. (2023). Outcome effects, moral luck, and the hindsight bias. Cognition, 232, 105258.

31 Güver, L., & Kneer, M. (2023). Causation, Foreseeability, and Norms. In Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (Vol. 45).

30 Kneer, M., & Viehoff, J. (2023). Are there Irrelevant Utilities? What the Folk Think (and Why This is Relevant). In Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (Vol. 45).

29 Mikalonytė, E. S. & Kneer, M. (2023). What is art? The role of intention, beauty and institutional recognition. In Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (Vol. 45).

28 Machery, E., Kneer, M., Willemsen, P. & Newen, A. (2023). Beyond the courtroom. Agency and the perception of free will. In Murray, S. & Henne, P. (eds.). Advances in Experimental Philosophy of Action. Bloomsbury Publishing

27 Baumgartner, L., & Kneer, M. (2023). What's the matter with 'reasonable'? In Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (Vol. 45).

26 Hannikainen, I. R., Tobia, K. P., de Almeida, G. D. F., Struchiner, N., Kneer, M., [...] & Żuradzki, T. (2022) Coordination and Expertise Foster Legal Textualism: A Multi-Country Investigation. Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, 119(44), e2206531119.

25 Kneer, M. & Hannikainen, I. R. (2022). Trolleys, triage and Covid-19: The role of psychological realism in sacrificial dilemmas. Cognition and Emotion.

24 Mikalonytė, E. S. & Kneer, M. (2022). Can artificial intelligence make art? ACM Transactions on Human-Robot Interaction. (Most downloaded paper in the history of the journal.)

23 Kneer, M. (2022). Contextualism vs. Relativism: More empirical data. In J. Wyatt, J. Zakkou & D. Zeman (eds.). Perspectives on Taste. Routledge.

22 Tolmeijer, S., Kandul, S., Kneer, M., Christen, M., & Bernstein, A. (2022) Capable but amoral? Comparing AI and human team members in moral decision-making contexts. Proceedings of the 2022 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (pp. 1-17). Honorable mention for best paper award (top 5%).

21 Kneer, M. (2022). Reasonableness on the Clapham Omnibus: Exploring the outcome- sensitive folk concept of reasonable. In Bystranowski, P., Janik, B. & Prochnicki, M. (eds.) Judicial Decision-Making: Integrating Empirical and Theoretical Perspectives (pp. 25-48). Springer International Publishing.

20 Güver, L. & Kneer, M. (2022). Causation and the silly norm effect. In S. Magen & K. Prochownik (eds.), Advances in Experimental Philosophy of Law. Bloomsbury Publishing (to appear). Runner-up for William James Prize at the Society for Philosophy & Psychology, 2021.

19 Kneer, M. (2021). Norms of assertion in the US, Germany & Japan. Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, 118 (37), e2105365118

18 Kneer, M. (2021). Can a robot lie? Cognitive Science, 45 (10), e13032.

17 Kneer, M. (2021). Predicates of personal taste, semantic incompleteness, and necessitarianism. Linguistics and Philosophy, 44(5), 981-1011.

16 Stuart, M. & Kneer, M. (2021). Guilty artificial minds: Folk Attributions of Mens Rea and Culpability to Artificially Intelligent Agents. Proc. of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction, 5(CSCW2), 1-27.

15 Kneer, M. (2021). Predicates of personal taste: empirical data. Synthese, 199(3-4), 6455-6471.

14 Kneer, M., & Stuart, M. T. (2021). Playing the blame game with robots. In Companion of the 2021 ACM/IEEE Int. Conference on Human-Robot Interaction, 407-411.

13 Frisch, L., Kneer, M., Krueger, J. & Ullrich, J. (2021) The Effect of Outcome Severity on Moral Judgment and Interpersonal Goals of Perpetrators, Victims, and Bystanders. European Journal of Social Psychology, 51(7), 1158-1171.

12 Kneer, M., Colaço, D., Alexander, J., & Machery, E. (2021). On second thought: Reflections on the Reflection Defense. In Lombrozo, T., Knobe, J., & Nichols, S. (eds.), Oxford Studies in Experimental Philosophy, Volume 4.

11 Hannikainen, I. R., Tobia, K. P., de Almeida, G. D. F., Donelson, R., Dranseika, V., Kneer, M., Strohmaier, N., Bystranowski, P., … & Struchiner, N. (2021). Are There Cross-Cultural Legal Principles? Modal Reasoning Uncovers Procedural Constraints on Law.' Cognitive Science 45 (9), e13024.

10 Kneer, M. (2021) Success and Knowledge in Action: Saving Anscombe's Account of Intentionality. In P. Grabarczyk and T. Ciecierski (eds.) Context Dependence in Language, Action, and Cognition, pp. 131-154. De Gruyter.

9 Cova, F., Strickland, B., Abatista, A.G.F., Allard, A., Andow, J., Attie, M., Beebe, J., Berniunas, R., Boudesseul, J., Colombo, M., Cushman, F., Díaz, R., van Dongen, N., Dranseika, V., Earp, B.D., Torres, A. G., Hannikainen, I.R., Hernández-Conde, J.V., Hu, W., Jacquet, F., Khalifa, K., Kim, H., Kneer, M., Knobe, J., Kurthy, M., Lantian, A., Liao, S., Machery, E., Moerenhout, T., Mott, C., Phelan, M., Rambharose, N., Reuter, K., Romero, F., Phillips, J.S., Sousa, P., Sprenger, J., Thalabard, E., Tobia, K., Viciana, H., Wilkenfeld, D.A., Zhou, X. (2021), Estimating the reproducibility of experimental philosophy. Review of Philosophy and Psychology, 12(1), 9-44.

8 Tolmeijer, S., Kneer, M., Sarasua, C., Christen, M., & Bernstein, A. (2020), Implementations in Machine Ethics: A Survey. ACM Computing Surveys (CSUR), 53(6), 1-38.

7 Kneer, M. & Machery, E. (2019). No luck for moral luck. Cognition (182), 331-348.

6 Kneer, M. (2018). The norm of assertion: Empirical data. Cognition (177C), 165-171.

5 Bourgeois-Gironde, S. & Kneer, M. (2018), Intention, cause, et responsabilité: Mens Rea et effet Knobe. In S. Ferey and F. G'Sell (eds.) Causalité, Responsabilité et Contribution à la Dette, pp. 117–144. Bruylant.

4 Kim, H., Kneer, M. & Stuart, M. (2018). The content-dependence of imaginative resistance. In F. Cova and S. Rénault (eds.) Advances in Experimental Philosophy of Aesthetics. Bloomsbury Publishing.

3 Kneer, M. (2018), Perspective and epistemic state ascriptions, Review of Philosophy and Psychology 9 (2), pp. 313-341.

2 Kneer, M. & Bourgeois-Gironde, S. (2017), Mens rea ascription, expertise and outcome effects: Professional judges surveyed. Cognition (169), pp. 139-146.

1 Kneer, M., Vicente, D. & Zeman, D. (2017), Relativism about predicates of personal taste and perspectival plurality. Linguistics & Philosophy (40), pp. 37-60.

Awards

2022	Best poster award, Society for Philosophy & Psychology and European Society for Philosophy & Psychology (w. L. Güver)

2021	Runner-up, William James Award for Best Paper, Society for Philosophy & Psychology (w. L. Güver)
2021	Best poster award, Society for Philosophy & Psychology (w. J. Olier)
2019–20	Fellowship, Digital Society Initiative, University of Zurich
2016	Fellowship, Italian Academy for Advanced Studies, Columbia University
2013	IDFA Academy, Amsterdam
2009–12	Doctoral Fellowship (Allocation Couplée), ENS Paris
2010–11	Kanbar Fellowship, New York University, NYC
2008–09	Procter Fellowship, Princeton University
2009	St. Gallen University Symposium Wings of Excellence Award
2007	Visiting Fellowship, Scuola Normale Superiore di Pisa
2006–09	Bourse d'élève (Statut de Normalien, Sélection Internationale), ENS Paris
2005	Goldman Sachs Foundation Global Leadership Award
2004–06	Fletcher Scholarship, Balliol College, Oxford University

Commissions of Trust

Editorial Responsibilities	Board Member, Ethical Theory and Moral Practice (2022–2025) Section Editor (Artificial Intelligence), Experimental Philosophy (new journal, publication beginning 2026) Section Editor, Philosophy of Artificial Intelligence (new journal, publication began 2025)
Peer Review & Evaluation	Ad hoc Referee: 20+ journals, including Noûs, Australasian Journal of Philosophy, Philosophical Studies, Synthese, Cognition, Review of Philosophy & Psychology, Cognitive Science. Grant Reviewing: ERC Consolidator Grant, The British Academy, Austrian Science Fund, Ernst Mach Foundation, University of Zurich.
Academic Committees	External Member, Faculty Hiring Committee, Professorship for Ethics and Philosophy of AI, Katholische Universität Eichstätt-Ingolstadt (2024) Member, Hiring Committee, NFP 77 "Meaningful Human Control of Security Systems", University of St. Gallen & University of Zurich (2021)
Examination Committees	External Examiner, PhD Dissertation Committee, Universidad de los Andes, Colombia (2025) Examiner, ten MA dissertations in Philosophy (University of Graz, University of Bochum) and Psychology (University of Zurich), 2018–present
Research Leadership & Governance	Steering Committee, IDea_Lab, University of Graz (2023–present) Co-founder, Corpus Linguistics & Philosophy Group, University of Zurich (2021) Co-founder, Digital Ethics Lab, University of Zurich (2020) Founder & Director, Guilty Minds Lab, University of Zurich (2019–present) Co-founder & Steering Committee, European Network for Experimental Philosophy (2019–present)

Conferences & Workshops Organized

2025	Organizer, Norms in Language-based Human-AI Interaction, International Conference, University of Graz
2024	Organizer, Ethics of AI and Human-Computer Interaction, International Conference, University of Graz
2020, 2021, 2023	Co-Organizer, Experimental Philosophy Europe, International Conferences
2023	Organizer, Workshop on Mark Alfano's Research, University of Zurich
2021	Organizer (with J. Garcia Olier), Mens Rea and Culpability, Symposium at the European Society for Philosophy and Psychology, Leipzig
	Organizer (with K. Reuter, P. Willemsen & L. Baumgartner), Introduction to Corpus Linguistics for Philosophers, International Workshop, University of Zurich
2020	Organizer (with M. Christen et al.), Trust in Autonomous Machines, Digital Society Initiative, University of Zurich
2019	Organizer, Epistemology in the Context of Criminal Law (with Jennifer Nagel), Centre for Ethics, University of Zurich
	Organizer, Reading Guilty Minds, Workshop at the IVR World Congress, University of Lucerne
	Organizer (with M. Christen & T. Burri), International Workshop on AI and Responsibility, University of Zurich
2017	Organizer (with J. Knobe & A. Egan), International Workshop on Perspectival Expressions, New York University
2016	Organizer (with K. Liefke), International Workshop on Situated Content, LMU Munich
2013	Organizer (with V. Tsompanidis & D. Zeman), 7th International Latin Meeting of Analytic Philosophy, École Normale Supérieure, Paris

Third-party Funding

2025–2028	'Norms in language-based Human-AI interaction'. CHANSE/HERA. 1'055'000 EUR. Project leader and leader of the four-country consortium.
2018–2023	'Reading guilty minds'. Swiss National Science Foundation, 840'000 EUR. Principal investigator.
2020–2024	NFP 77 'Meaningful Human Control of Security Systems'. Swiss National Science Foundation, 600'000 EUR. Co-author of proposal and project partner. PI: T. Burri.
2018/2020	'When algorithms decide in our stead: Challenges of AI'. Swiss Centre for Technology Assessment (TA Swiss), 180'000 EUR. Co-applicant and project partner. PI: M. Christen.
2018–2022	'Geography of Philosophy'. Templeton Foundation Project, University of Pittsburgh. 3.2 million USD. PIs: E. Machery, H.C. Barrett, S. Stich. Associated Researcher.

Selected Recent Talks

More than 130 scientific talks at renowned universities and institutions such as Yale, Columbia, Oxford, Cambridge, ETH Zurich, École Normale Supérieure Paris, and several Max Planck Institutes.

2026	'Forward-looking moral responsibility in human-AI interaction', LMU Munich
	'Should AI play by our rules?', Italian Institute for Cognitive Sciences and Technologies, Rome
2025	'Value Forks', Keynote, Society of Philosophy of AI, Amsterdam
	'Attributing Intentionality', Conference on Legal Methodology, Cambridge University
	'Norms of assertion for humans and artificial agents', Max Planck Institute for Human Development, Berlin
	'AI Alignment', Keynote, Centre for AI, University of Koper, Slovenia
	'Moral Luck, the Law & AI', Conference on Law & AI organized by the Max Planck Institute for Research on Collective Goods Bonn, held in Naples
	'Value Forks and LLM Alignment', Chair of Ethics of AI, LMU Munich
2024	'Biases in Mens Rea Attribution & How to Address Them', CEU Vienna
	'Norms of AI Assertion', Ethics of Socially Disruptive Technologies Network, Utrecht University
	'AI Alignment in health applications and beyond', Keynote, World Health Organization (WHO) meeting, Monte Verità

Teaching

University of Graz	2 x Ethics of AI (undergraduate course, part of the university's new micro-degree in AI, which I co-conceived), Fall & spring 2024/25, Fall & spring 2025/26
	2 x Ethics of AI (graduate seminar), Fall 2024, Spring 2026
	Experimental Philosophy, Spring 2026
	Large Language Models – Perspectives from Philosophy and Cognitive Science, Fall 2025
	Philosophy of Language and Digital Communication (graduate course), Spring 2025
	Introduction to IT Law, University of Graz (several lectures in lecture series), Spring 2024
University of Zurich	Digital Ethics Lab, Digital Society Initiative, Fall 2022 (graduate), Spring 2021 (graduate)
	Blame and Punishment, Dept. of Philosophy, Fall 2021 (undergraduate)
	Ethics of Artificial Intelligence, ASAE Ethics Master program (graduate)
	2x Replicable Empirical Research in Social Psychology (w. J. Ullrich), Dept. of Psychology, Spring 2020, Spring 2019 (graduate)
	ASAE Ethics of Economics (co-lecturer), Dept. of Philosophy, Fall 2019 (undergraduate)
	Ethics & Artificial Intelligence (w. M. Christen), Dept. of Informatics, Spring 2019 (undergraduate)
University Vita-Salute San Raffaele, Milan	Experimental Philosophy of Language, Philosophy Department, Spring 2022 (graduate)
University of Pittsburgh	Experimental Philosophy Laboratory (w. E. Machery), Dept. of Philosophy of Science, 2015-2017 (graduate)
	Myth & Science, Dept. of Philosophy of Science, Spring 2016 (graduate)
Paris Institute of Political Studies (Sciences Po)	The Right to the City & Radical Democracy, Dept. of Political Science, Spring 2015 (undergraduate)
	Civil Disobedience, Dept. of Political Science, Fall 2014 (undergraduate)

	Spatial Justice in Urban Environments, Dept. of Political Science, Fall 2014 (undergraduate)
	Introduction to Civil Disobedience, Dept. of Political Science, Spring 2014 (undergraduate)
Université Panthéon-Assas, Paris	Economics of Global Security, Game theory, Dept. of Economics, Spring 2015 (graduate)
	2x Theory of Conflict, Game theory, Dept. of Economics, Spring 2013 (graduate)
Paris College of Art (formerly Parsons Paris)	Visual Culture, Fall 2013 (undergraduate)
Université Charles de Gaulle, Lille	Philosophy of Mind, two courses, 2009/10 (undergraduate)

Summer Schools

2022	International Summer School in Affective Sciences, Emotions & Well-being, Château de Bossey, Switzerland. Organized by the University of Geneva.
2021	Law, Language and Philosophy Summer School, Dubrovnik. Organized by the Jagiellonian Center for Law, Language and Philosophy, University of Krakow.
2019	Trust in Artificial Intelligence. Organized by the German Academic Scholarship Foundation, Ludwig Maximilian University Munich.

Supervision

	Supervision and co-supervision of more than a dozen BA, MA and PhD candidates in Philosophy, Psychology, Law and HRI at the Universities of Zurich and Graz. Currently also supervising several postdoctoral researchers at the University of Graz in Ethics of AI and HRI.

Expertise and Outreach Activities

2026	"Why we dislike AI art", German Academy of Art, Villa Massimo, Rome
	Panel discussion on fake news, ECOnet Graz
	Panel discussion on AI-driven political parties, Johannes Kepler University Linz
	"Can AI Make Art?" Graz Generate Festival
2025	"Value Forks", Graz University, IDea_Lab
	"Artificial Intelligence and Art", Austrian Consulate, Zurich
2024	"Ethics of AI", ARQUS Lecture, University of Graz
	"Ethics of AI". Austrian Consulate, Munich
	"The Inclusiveness of AI". Panel Discussion, Technology Impact Summit, Graz
	Interview on autonomous weapon systems, Kleine Zeitung, Austria
	Panel Discussion about artificial intelligence, Pfingstdialoge, Forum Alpbach
	"Ethics of AI". Public lecture at University of Graz Alumni Association
	"How to finetune Large Language Models." Presentation at Google Zurich
	Organizer & Moderator of Panel Discussion on Risks and Chances of AI, Graz University

	Public Lecture on ethical aspects of AI and big data. Zurich Data Protection Festival, organized by the Office for Data Protection of the canton Zurich
	Public lecture on philosophical concepts of happiness. Zurich Philosophy Festival
2023	Interview on risks of artificial intelligence, Kleine Zeitung, Austria
	Panel Discussion on AI Ethics, St. Paulus Akademie, Zurich
2022	Newspaper article on consciousness and AI for Swiss newspaper Republik
	Interview with Wired on artificial intelligence
2020	Swiss Digital Day, Panel Discussion on TV, "How intelligent is AI?"
	Ethics & AI Panel discussion, Renuo Entrepreneur Workshop
2019	Public lecture on autonomy and virtual assistants, Zurich Philosophy Festival
	Panel discussion on the future of AI in medical diagnosis, MPA Congress, Davos
	Public lecture about the Turing test and machine intelligence, Scientifica, ETH Zurich & University of Zurich
	Expert, Swiss Foundation for Technology Assessment (TA-Swiss), workshop on self-driving cars
2018	Participant, panel discussion about the film 'The truth about killer robots', Zurich Film Festival
	Participant, United Nations Meeting of the Group of Governmental Experts of the High Contracting Parties to the CCW on Lethal Autonomous Weapons Systems (LAWS) – 1st session, Geneva
2017	Expert, Roundtable of the International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC) on ethics and autonomous weapon systems, Geneva